

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1180-5 (Br Adj)

June 2025

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING
RECORD OF DISCUSSION –
TUESDAY, 13 MAY 2025

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Co-Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Martin Girard (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Major-General Dave Yarker
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel Steeve Lavoie
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Renay Groves
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Mr. Geoffrey Priems
Member / Previous Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Josee Robidoux (Retired) - REGRETS
Member / Previous Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert (Retired)
Member / Previous Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt - REGRETS
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Francois Robichaud
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Walter Norquay - REGRETS
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Mark Parsons
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert
Member / CO C&E Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Geneviève Audet

Member / Home Station Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Jason McQuigge - REGRETS
Guest / 2 nd Book of Remembrance OPI	Brigadier-General Kevin O’Keefe (Retired)
Guest / AFCEA	Colonel Walter Wood (Retired)
Guest / OC Museum	Major Scott Oikle
Guest / Museum Rep	Mr. Rory Cory
Guest / D RCCS Res	LCol Lisa Smid
Guest / HSSO	Capt Simon Grant
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gregory McDonald

DISCUSSION

OPENING REMARKS
1. The Colonel Commandant provided opening remarks and mentioning his recent visits to C&E units. He identified recruitment/retention and limited CELE history knowledge as two themes that stuck out during his visits.
REVIEW OF ROD OF PREVIOUS SENATE MEETING
1. The previous meeting’s Record of Discussion (ROD) was reviewed. No concerns were raised, and the Action Items were noted.

REPORT I – BRANCH OFFICE REPORT

1. The Branch Adjutant presented the Branch Office Report, including:
 - a. **HR.** Updates on vacant Lieutenant Colonel Class A positions (Branch Affairs Officer and a new 125th Anniversary position), the new Branch Adjutant (Major Emily Circé), and vacancies for Bandmaster and Sergeant Chief Clerk, plus support staff updates.
 - b. **Educational Bursary Update.** The solicitation message has been released; the nomination deadline is July 31, 2025.
 - c. **Finances.** A fiscal update from FY24/25 was provided to close out the FY. The budget for FY25/26 was presented.
 - d. **Branch Fund Bulletin.** Discussion ensued on whether it was a minimum viable product for distribution. It was proposed that the bulletin described the “what” of the Branch Funds, but not the “why”. It was decided to use the bulletin as-is, but to update it based on feedback from units/C&E members.
 - e. **Branch Manual.** The Branch Adjutant identified changes that will be made to the Branch Standing Orders, including the name change to Branch Manual to align with other Branches and Regiments.
 - f. **Branch Ambassador Program.** The Branch Chief then provided details on the Branch Ambassador Program, highlighting that ambassadors are organically identified (not thru chain of command), they vary in rank widely (up to LCol), and they are selected based on the initiatives they’ve created for the Branch.
2. Discussion ensued on the NCR Mess Dinner and ROSEN dinner invitation distribution. A detailed discussion followed about the P070 fund, contributions through CanadaHelps and Zeffy, and how to increase the number of contributions.

Action

1. Branch Office: Upload Branch Fund Bulletin on CMCEN. Update the bulletin based on feedback.
2. Branch Office: Include Branch Ambassador Program details in the Branch Manual

Report II – Foundation Report

1. The Foundation President presented the Foundation Report. Topics included the annual grants from the Foundation to the Branch Fund and the Museum, the communication plan, switching the Zeffy for donations, and the development of an eBook on how members can contribute to their heritage. Further, the Foundation stressed that they want to support as many people as possible, that the Calendar plug-in for CMCEN was purchased outright (instead of annual subscription), and that CMCEN needs a refresh. Discussion transitioned to the Educational Bursary program. There were mixed viewpoints on it and it was highlighted that a new CANFORGEN was released which opens Education Reimbursement up to Reg F members again (similar to how CFMWS has the

same programs we provide). Questions were then posed about Zeffy to clarify how it differs from CanadaHelps. Zeffy enables 100% of the contribution to reach the Foundation, provides payment services for registration at events (such as C&E Mess Dinner), and how different information can be tracked through it (such as which unit the member is from). During discussions on the eBook, the Br Leader suggested that the focus not be on how to support the museum, but instead how to support “your heritage”. Conversations turned to the Branch Fund, with emphasis on the need to communicate that the Branch Fund is more than just the Distress Fund and that the C&E Association can contribute funds to C&E Family members in distress as well.

Report III – Association Report

1. The Association President provided the Association Report, which highlighted the Association is a member of the National Council of Veterans Associations, 18 King Charles III Coronation medal nominations were submitted and approved, the book “A History of CFCC” has been published and is available through the Mercury Shop, the second book of remembrance is being developed, the requirement to bolster CMCEN support, the requirement to find a replacement for the outgoing President, and the potential for the Association to support recruitment initiatives. The requirement to publish the approved governance structure of the C&E Family on CMCEN was also noted. During the presentation, questions were raised on some topics.
2. AFCEA identified that that, in consideration of how PD is a focus of C&E Week, AFCEA would like to recreate the CAF Net Ops Symposium in Kingston. With respect to the desire to have more Board members, it was clarified that all serving members are automatically members of the Association. C&E unit honorary appointments (e.g. HCOLs) can be part of the board as well. For recruiting support, discussion ensued on how the Foundation, Museum and Association can support recruitment drives and job fairs similar to the old Signals Attraction Team, as well as how P Res and Reg F can support each other at these job fairs. The Col Cmdt identified that he would reach out to HCOLs and HLCOLs to determine how they can support these initiatives.

Action

1. Branch Office: Lead a broader discussion on collaborative recruitment opportunities and brief the Senate on the results during the Fall Senate meeting.
2. Branch Office: Update C&E Branch Manual to include the approved governance structure of the C&E Family

Report IV – Museum Report

1. The Museum Manager provided the Museum Report which included the attendance from April 2024 to March 2025, the results of the March of the Museums, the financial summary of 2024/25, the plan moving forward, an update on the expansion proposal, and the Highway of Heroes Military Museums initiative. Discussions ensued which focuses on the expansion and historical efforts to look at the placement of the museum, and the governance of the museum.

Action

1. Branch Office: Facilitate feedback on OC Museum’s draft governance document.

Old Business I – Communications Plan Update (“Communicators Communicating”)
2. Communications Plan Update ("Communicators Communicating") was skipped due to time constraints. Note that the planned survey needs redevelopment with the focus being on understanding member needs.
Old Business II – 125th Anniversary Planning
3. The 125th Anniversary Planning was skipped due to time constraints. Note that planning is in the early stages. The C&E Branch position “125 th Anniversary LCol” has been approved, but work is ongoing to enter the position in the system before it can be announced as a REO.
New Business I – 2nd Book of Remembrance
1. BGen (Retd) Kevin O’Keefe provided an update on the project to create a second Book of Remembrance. The project aims to complete the existing "World of Canadian Forces Signals, Book of Remembrance" (up to 1968) and create a new "living document" for those who died in service from 1968 onwards, to be displayed at the museum and digitally accessible. Former community member Rick Trafford (calligrapher for Veterans Affairs Canada) has volunteered for the new book. The design will be presented to the Senate for approval, and the completed book will be formally presented to the museum. Of note, there are a few discrepancies that will need to be decided upon by a adjudication committee (Senate to fulfill this role) with the rule of thumb for acceptance being the VAC criteria, but there will be exceptions no doubt. Action 1. Branch Office: Develop management guidelines for the 2nd Book of Remembrance (e.g. criteria, decision making).
New Business II – Relationship with AFCEA Ottawa Chapter
1. The President of the AFCEA Ottawa Chapter provided an overview of their organization, including the size, general membership breakdown, and their ability to run events. A key aspect of AFCEA is their ability to bring military, industry, academia and government together in the C5ISR space. Ideas were discussed on how to leverage the connection between AFCEA and the C&E Family to everyone’s benefit. Discussions consisted of AFCEA taking more technology focus, AFCEA’s desire to reinvigorate the CAF Net Ops Symposium in Kingston, and the potential to establish a more formalized relationship between AFCEA and the C&E Family. Action 1. Branch Office: Work with AFCEA to explore CAF Net Ops-type Symposium options.
Open forum / CLOSING REMARKS

1. The Branch Leader reiterated the action items from the meeting. The Col Cmdt reinforced BGen (Ret'd) Kevin O'Keefe's idea to incorporate past Col Cmdts in the 125th Anniversary. The Branch Leader concluded by thanking the Home Station Cmdt and the Branch Adjt for their work, as they will both be moving on this summer.

Brigadier-General Martin Girard, OMM, MSM, CD (Retired)
Branch Colonel Commandant

Major-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader